

Question Paper

Exam Date & Time: 05-Jan-2026 (09:30 AM - 12:30 PM)



MANIPAL ACADEMY OF HIGHER EDUCATION

FIRST SEMESTER B.TECH. DEGREE EXAMINATIONS - DEC 2025 / JAN 2026
SUBJECT: HUM 1071/HUM_1071 COMMUNICATION SKILLS IN ENGLISH

Marks: 50

Duration: 180 mins.

Answer all the questions.

1A) Identify the grammatically correct sentence in the following: (1)

[Law relating to slavery provide a good example of this.](#)

[Laws relating to slavery provide a good example of this.](#)

[Laws relating to slavery provides a good example of this.](#)

[Laws related to slavery providing a good example of this.](#)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

1B) Identify the grammatically correct sentence in the following: (1)

[This is the grain of truth glimpsed by many of the stereotypes cited in the earlier parts of this essay.](#)

[This was the grains of truth glimpsed by many of the stereotypes cited in the earlier parts of this aessay.](#)

[This was the grain of truth glimpsed by many of the stereotypes cited in the earlier part of this assay.](#)

[This were the grain of truth glimpsed by many of the stereotype cited in the earlier parts of this assay.](#)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

1C) Identify the grammatically correct sentence in the following: (1)

[We must never forget ours is a nation who entered the modern era through a history of defeat and subjection.](#)

[We must never forget that our's was a nation that entered the modern era through history of defeat and subjection.](#)

[We must never forget that ours is a nation that entered the modern era through a history of defeat and subjection.](#)

[We must never forget that ours is a nation that entered the modern era through an history of defeat and subjection.](#)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

1D) Complete the sentence by choosing the appropriate linker listed below. (1)

I know a woman who hates domestic work, _____ she pretends that she likes it, _____ she has been taught that to be "good wife material", she has to be homely.

[but.](#)

[and.](#)

[so.](#)

[since, although](#)

[because](#)

[and](#)

[since](#)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

1E) Identify the grammatically correct sentence in the following: (1)

[A curtain of illusions could descends over the whole of humanity.](#)

[An curtain of illusions could descend over a whole of humanity.](#)

[A curtains of illusions could descend over the whole of humanity.](#)

[A curtain of illusions could descend over the whole of humanity.](#)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

- 1F) Complete the sentence by choosing the appropriate linker listed below (1)
Even musical instruments _____ their caste properties; a vina, no less than icon of a god, _____ to be made by a particular caste or family.
Are. Have, has Has, has Are.
is have

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

- 1G) Choose the correct answer to fill in the blanks. (1)
We _____ evolved but our ideas of gender _____ not evolved much.
have, have had, was are, are has, has

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

- 1H) Choose the correct answer to fill in the blanks. (1)
_____ gender can be uncomfortable, there are easy ways to close this conversation.
So And But Because

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

- 1I) Choose the correct answer (1)
When he came back, the two gentlemen were quarrelling furiously.
State the antonym of furious.
calm angry jealous fight

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

- 1J) Choose the correct answer (1)
The time to reckon with AI is before our politics, our economy and our daily life become dependent on it.
What does to reckon mean?
To deal To abandon To ignore To
with doubt

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Understand"

Answer all the questions.

Answer the following question in about 350- 400 words:

- 2) According to AK Ramanujam, 'Indians do not mean what they say and say different things at different times'. Do you agree with the author? Elaborate. (10)

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Analysis"

- 3) In the text "Computers and Spinning Wheels," Amitav Ghosh compares the computer and the spinning wheel. What do these two symbols mean, and how does he use them to talk about India's progress and values? (10)

Course Outcome: "CO2" / Cognitive Level: "Analysis"

- 4) **Read the following passage and provide a response to the question in about 300-350 words. Your response is required to show a critical understanding of the ideas presented in the passage.** (10)

On Going Home
Joan Didion

I am home for my daughter's first birthday. By "home" I do not mean the house in Los Angeles where my husband and I and the baby live, but the place where my family is, in the Central Valley of California. It is a vital although troublesome distinction. My husband likes my family but is uneasy in their house, because once there I fall into their ways, which are difficult, oblique, deliberately inarticulate, not my husband's ways. We live in dusty houses ("D-U-S-T," he once wrote with his finger on surfaces all over the house, but no one noticed it) filled with mementos quite without value to him (what could the Canton dessert plates mean to him? how could he have known about the assay scales, why should he care if he did know?), and we appear to talk exclusively about people we know who have been committed to mental hospitals, about people we know who have been booked on drunk-driving charges, and about property, particularly about property, land, price per acre and C-2 zoning and assessments and freeway access. My brother does not understand my husband's inability to perceive the advantage in the rather common real-estate transaction known as "sale-leaseback," and my husband in turn does not understand why so many of the people he hears about in my father's house have been recently committed to mental hospitals or booked on drunk-driving charges. Nor does he understand that when we talk about sale leasebacks and right-of-way condemnations, we are talking in code about things we like best, the yellow fields and the cottonwoods and the rivers rising and falling and the mountain roads closing when the heavy snow comes in. We miss each other's points, have another drink and regard the fire. My brother refers to my husband, in his presence, as "Joan's husband." Marriage is the classic betrayal.

Or perhaps it is not any more. Sometimes, I think that those of us who are now in our thirties were born into the last generation to carry the burden of "home," to find in family life the source of all tension and drama. I had by all objective accounts a "normal" and a "happy" family situation, and yet I was almost thirty years old before I could talk to my family on the telephone without crying after I had hung up. We did not fight. Nothing was wrong. And yet some nameless anxiety colored the emotional charges between me and the place that I came from. The question of whether or not you could go home again was a very real part of the sentimental and largely literary baggage with which we left home in the fifties; I suspect that it is irrelevant to the children born of the fragmentation after World War II. A few weeks ago in a San Francisco bar I saw a pretty young girl on crystal take off her clothes and dance for the cash prize in an "amateur topless" contest. There was no particular sense of moment about this, none of the effect of romantic degradation, of "dark journey," for which my generation strived so assiduously. What sense could that girl possibly make of, say, *Long Day's Journey into Night*? Who is beside the point?

That I am trapped in this particular irrelevancy is never more apparent to me than when I am home. Paralyzed by the neurotic lassitude engendered by meeting one's past at every turn, around every corner, inside every cupboard, I go aimlessly from room to room. I decide to meet it head-on and clear out a drawer, and I spread the contents on the bed. A bathing suit I wore the summer I was seventeen. A letter of rejection from The Nation, an aerial photograph of the site for a shopping center my father did not build in 1954. Three teacups hand-painted with cabbage roses and sign "E.M.," my grandmother's initials. There is no final solution for letters of rejection from The Nation and teacups handpainted in 1900. Nor is there any answer to snapshots of one's grandfather as a young man on skis, surveying around Donner Pass in the year 1910. I smooth out the snapshot and look into his face, and do and do not see my own. I close the drawer and have another cup of coffee with my mother. We get along very well, veterans of a guerilla war we never understood. Days pass. I see no one. I come to dread my husband's evening call, not only because he is full of news of what by now seems to me our remote life in Los Angeles, people he has seen, letters which require attention, but because he asks what I have been doing, suggests uneasily that I get out, drive to San Francisco or Berkeley. Instead I drive across the river to a family graveyard. It has been vandalized since my last visit and the monuments are broken, overturned in the dry grass. Because I once saw a rattlesnake in the grass I stay in the car and listen to a country-and-Western station. Later I drive with my father to a ranch he has in the foothills. The man who runs his cattle on it asks us to the round-up, a week from Sunday, and although I know that I will be in Los Angeles I say, in the oblique way my family talks, that I will come. Once home I mention the broken monuments in the graveyard. My mother shrugs.

I go to visit my great-aunts. A few of them think now that I am my cousin, or their daughter who died young. We recall an anecdote about a relative last seen in 1948, and they ask if I still like living in New York City. I have lived in Los Angeles for three years, but I say that I do. The baby is offered a horehound drop, and I am slipped a dollar bill "to buy a treat." Questions trail off, answers are abandoned, the baby plays with the dust motes in a shaft of the afternoon sun.

It is time for the baby's birthday party: a white cake, strawberry marshmallow ice cream, a bottle of

champagne saved from another party. In the evening, after she has gone to sleep, I kneel beside the crib and touch her face, where it is pressed against the slats, with mine. She is an open and trusting child, unprepared for and unaccustomed to the ambushes of family life, and perhaps it is just as well that I can offer her little of that life. I would like to give her more. I would like to promise her that she will grow up with a sense of her cousins and of rivers and her great-grandmother's teacups, would like to pledge her a picnic on a river with fried chicken and her hair uncombed, would like to give her *home* for her birthday, but we live differently now and I can promise her nothing like that. I give her a xylophone and a sundress from Madeira, and promise to tell her a funny story.

Question:

In "On Going Home", Didion honestly confronts her feelings about her parents, her husband, her child, and the passage of time. In attempting not to deceive herself she gains a measure of what might be called 'self-respect', or 'self-understanding'. How and why do people deceive themselves? Why is self-deception so difficult to overcome? Finally, what does it mean to have self-respect? Write an essay in which you develop your answers to these questions.

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Analysis"

Write an essay on any ONE of the following topics in about 600 words.

- 5) **A.** Social media addiction is real, and it can damage careers, degrade life and even harm relationships. How does social media affect real life relationships? Elucidate. (10)
- OR**
- B.** Freedom is not the absence of restraint, but the presence of choice. Do you agree?

Course Outcome: "CO1" / Cognitive Level: "Analysis"

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Event Name		Subject	
058-MIT BLR-MAKEUP EXAM-2025-2026		HUM_1071:COMMUNICATION SKILLS IN ENGLISH	
#	Course Outcome	Description	Marks
1	1	CO 1	40
2	2	CO 2	10
Total			50

* **NA** - CO Not Selected

Event Name		Subject	
058-MIT BLR-MAKEUP EXAM-2025-2026		HUM_1071:COMMUNICATION SKILLS IN ENGLISH	
#	Level	No of Questions	Marks (%)
1	Remember	0	0(0%)
2	Understand	10	10(20%)
3	Application	0	0(0%)
4	Analysis	4	40(80%)
5	Create	0	0(0%)
6	Evaluate	0	0(0%)
Total		14	50 (100%)